

Un-detectable Cycle

WordPress Sites used to redirect users to malware affected websites. Read here more: <http://dgit.in/wordpsmlware>



Let's Kickstart!

If you just want to Kickstart something, but just cant figure out what? Take this quiz to know it: <http://dgit.in/ksstrtanythng>

LETTER OF THE MONTH

✉ I'm a retired Govt. employee of West Bengal, now living in a village and reading Digit since September 2001. This is with regard to Siddharth's editorial 'Bottoms up'.

National e-governance plan is an initiative of the GOI to make all government services available via electronic means. However, who will provide these services? In most district offices of both the State and the Central governments, about half the sanctioned posts are vacant, and a large percentage of existing employees are old, and reluctant to learn computer-based tech. Most of the district heads are also ignorant after their short course of training. As a result, government services are unsatisfactory. The government can name all the schemes and projects it wants, but successful implementation is never done due to a lack of proper vigilance.

You stated that e-governance is much needed to curb corruption, fraud etc. The PAHAL scheme was introduced to stop corruption in the domestic gas supply system and to save money in the form of subsidy. Let's look at an example to see why corruption will continue: Two persons, namely A and B, are using LPG under the PAHAL scheme. A requires 9 cylinders per year and B requires 6. Both live in a rural area. I was astonished to learn that their gas cylinders are being booked during the unbooked months by the dealer/distributor and gas

cylinders are sold in the open market for personal profit. Subsidies for these cylinders are also being transferred to the Bank account of A & B. Thus, the government loses money for $3 + 6 = 9$ cylinders @ ₹208.18 for each = ₹1,873.62 per year due to the hacking of PAHAL accounts by the dealer/distributor. That can be averaged to ₹900 per person per year!



The new government relaunched the Kisan Vikas Patra (KVP) scheme, but the certificates aren't available in rural post offices. I got one in March 2015, then another in May 2015, and since then no more certificates have been available. I wrote emails to the Chief Post Master General W.B. and the Secretary, Department of Posts, GOI, but got no acknowledgement, let alone a reply.

You've rightly said that technology is the only thing that can change this. Very few students in rural areas know computers, and this is what needs to change. We need to make computer science compulsory in the syllabus. E-learning would also help. The common student has to spend a lot for private tuitions, despite the big budget by the government for education.

I should mention some positives as well: The Directorate of Public Grievances (dpg.gov.in) is doing a good job. Anyone can file a complaint against any department on its site. One kilometer of concrete road is being paved in every village, the MGNREGA schemes are being successfully implemented, I can

withdraw pension from an ATM in a remote village, purchase railway and air tickets from home, pay my telephone and electric bill and send money via net banking, and electricity and water are being supplied to each village.

– Tapas Jana

📌 Siddharth will respond to you personally later, as he's travelling currently. For the time being, you have me. You're right, life in India cannot be called fair, not for a vast majority of people. However, although systems have been discouraging thus far, we believe technology really will change all of this.

We're still playing catch up, and not just with first world countries, but also some developing countries in some fields. Social networking means that politicians can no longer get away with mediocrity, and it also means that services of not just private entities, but also public and government entities are open to both, ridicule and praise. We can now see what's happening around the globe thanks to services such as YouTube, or talks such as TED. It's called "Information Technology" for a reason... it allows more and more people to be informed.

Yes, you'll have various politicians jumping up and down claiming this as their doing, but the truth is, it's inevitable. The best a politician can do is to not stand in the way of this progress. Besides, it's our tax money that they "allocate" anyway, so really, it's the people of India and technology that will improve it, slowly, but surely, and nothing can stop that change!

– Robert

📌 Well, there are a couple of things you could do:

1. Since you're interested in gaming you could send in writeups for SKOAR!
2. You could join our writers programme.
3. You could also send in features for our Community pages, which have been showcasing reader contributions for quite a while now.

– Siddharth

✉ Just noticed. The femtometre scale numbers are messed up. The -15 appears as normal text (10⁻¹⁵) instead of a superscript (10⁻¹⁵). Had me confused for a second.

Cheers.

– Tanuj Baru

📌 Yes, that was my mistake, sorry. I wrote it in Google Docs, and forgot to

check if the numbers had been displayed properly in our layout software, InDesign. We noticed it just after the printing started, sadly. We've uploaded the corrected PDF to give away for free to everyone, and also included it in the DVD this month. Go to <http://dgit.in/dmystify0715> to download the PDF. Again, my sincere apologies to all our readers.

– Robert